



Gunports—
this galleon
carried about
30 guns

Galleon
Spain 1500s

Main mast rose
205 ft (62.5 m) above
the waterline

Rigging is made
of about 26 miles
(42 km) of rope

Narrow hull
cut through the
water quickly

Foreward-
firing gun

A crew of
850 lived aboard
Admiral Nelson's
187-ft- (57-m-)
long warship.

HMS VICTORY



Five school
buses

Three masts
support a total
of 37 sails

Giant bowsprit
extends 100 ft (30 m)
beyond ship's bow

HMS Victory England 1765

With
140 guns,
Santissima Trinidad
was the most heavily
armed ship in the
world.

Lower gundeck
housed 30 giant
32-pounder guns

Fourth gundeck
added later to a
three-deck ship

Santissima Trinidad Spain 1769

Brig France 1800

Twin masts and a narrow
hull makes the ship fast
and maneuverable

cannons fired through flaps called gunports, in the hull. To boost firepower, some ships were built with extra decks of guns. This led to three-decker warships, such as the *St. Michael*, which fought in the Caribbean, and the *Santissima Trinidad*, which later received a fourth deck of heavy guns.

This made her menacing, but slow. Flagships, such as the French navy's *La Reale*, were home to a fleet's commander. **HMS Victory** was the flagship under British admiral Lord Nelson at the battle of Trafalgar. With 104 guns, she was a formidable, as well as fast, fighting machine.